



HVAC Technician

hvac-technician • 3-5 year apprenticeship

\$50K-\$70K / yr

THE TRADE

Install, maintain, and repair the heating, cooling, and ventilation systems buildings depend on. Demand never quits — heating in winter, cooling in summer — and the path from zero experience to licensed technician is one of the fastest in the trades.

SALARY & TRAINING

JOURNEYMAN BAND (SITE FIGURE — SAME AS QUIZ RESULT & TRADES PAGE)

\$50K-\$70K

BLS median \$57,310 (blog-cited) • apprentice 3-5 yr, 6,000-8,000 OJT hrs
• EPA 608 required from day one

THE PATH: FROM RESEARCH TO HIRED

01 RESEARCH Compare training routes, union vs non-union, and local demand

02 TRAIN Trade school / pre-apprenticeship — start with OSHA 10

03 HANDS-ON Apprentice years: log hours, earn raises to 80-90% of scale

04 CERTIFIED Pass the journeyman or industry certification exam

05 HIRED Journey-level pay — specialize, stack certs, own the shop

Every apprentice track pays from day one — typical start is 40-50% of journey scale with scheduled raises every year. Each step above is fully mapped on the TradeLift Getting Started guide and the site's resources page.



REQUIRED CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

EPA Section 608 — legally required to handle refrigerants

YOUR FIRST 12 WEEKS — THE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Take the TradeLift quiz to confirm fit ☐ Earn your OSHA 10 online
- ☐ Pass EPA 608 Universal (core/AC/heating) ☐ Get First Aid/CPR certified
- ☐ Draft a one-page trade resume ☐ Call a local HVAC shop or union
- ☐ Search apprenticeship.gov HVAC roles ☐ Buy gauges, a multimeter, hand tools
- ☐ Shadow a service tech for a day ☐ Apply to 3 programs (union + private)
- ☐ Practice brazing and soldering pipe ☐ Keep a clean driver's record handy

Full career steps, certifications, and tool guides: <https://tradelift.surge.sh/getting-started.html>